

devine-1989-stereotypes-and-prejudice--their-automatic-a

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Paper Synthesis

Paper: devine-1989-stereotypes-and-prejudice--their-automatic-and-controlled-components

Executive Summary

The paper investigates whether automatic stereotype activation and controlled inhibition differ between high- and low-prejudice individuals. It finds that both groups possess equivalent knowledge of Black stereotypes and exhibit equally strong automatic activation, but only low-prejudice participants can intentionally inhibit stereotype-consistent thoughts, highlighting a controlled process distinction. This supports a model separating automatic activation from controlled belief regulation in prejudice.

Reading Recommendation

Read Selectively

The paper offers a seminal test of the automatic-controlled dissociation model with three experiments that collectively support the claim that automatic stereotype activation is equivalent across prejudice levels while controlled inhibition differs. However, moderate methodological concerns (e.g., lack of power analysis, ambiguous task design in Study 2, and unaddressed alternative models) limit confidence in the broader theoretical generalizations. Senior readers should focus on the introduction, the detailed methods and results of Studies 1-3, and the

general discussion.

Background and Motivation

The paper addresses the unresolved question of whether high- and low-prejudice individuals differ in their automatic and controlled responses to stereotyped group members, a gap highlighted despite extensive evidence that stereotypes are well-learned, automatically activated associations (e.g., Dovidio, Evans, & Tyler 1986; Smith & Branscombe 1985) and that controlled processes can override such activation (Higgins & King 1981). Prior work has shown early formation of stereotypes (Allport 1954) and the distinction between cultural stereotypes and personal beliefs (Katz 1976), yet it remains unclear if prejudice level moderates the interplay of automatic activation and controlled inhibition. This study therefore builds on these foundations to test knowledge equivalence, automatic activation equivalence, and controlled inhibition across prejudice levels.

Theoretical Stance

Overall stance: Consistent Theoretical

The paper's introduction presents the automatic-controlled dissociation model as its central framework, and the general discussion repeatedly cites the empirical findings as support for this model while explicitly rejecting the inevitability-of-prejudice account, indicating alignment between theory and results.

Theories Discussed

- **automatic vs controlled processes model** (*focal*): Posits a dissociation between automatic stereotype activation (unintentional, well-learned associations) and controlled processes (intentional inhibition and activation of personal beliefs) that together determine prejudiced versus nonprejudiced responses.
- **stereotype vs personal belief structures distinction** (*background*): Claims that cultural stereotypes are long-standing cognitive structures separate from newer, consciously endorsed personal beliefs about a group.
- **inevitability of prejudice framework** (*alternative*): Argues that as long as cultural stereotypes exist, prejudice inevitably follows because stereotypes are automatically applied, regardless of personal beliefs.
- **tripartite model of attitudes** (*alternative*): Treats stereotypes as the cognitive component of attitudes, integrating them directly into the attitude structure rather than separating them from personal beliefs.

- **habit-breaking analogy for prejudice reduction** (*background*): Uses the metaphor of breaking a bad habit to describe the process of inhibiting automatic stereotype-congruent responses and replacing them with nonprejudiced thoughts.
- **automatic activation independent of attitudes** (*background*): The claim that automatically activated stereotype-congruent responses occur regardless of an individual's current attitudes or beliefs.

Study Design

- **Number of experiments:** 3
- **Predictors examined:** prejudice level (high vs low)
- **Outcomes examined:** stereotype knowledge (free-response content), evaluation of ambiguous stereotype-relevant behavior (congruent vs incongruent ratings), thought-listing responses (frequency of stereotype-congruent vs equality-focused thoughts)
- **Materials:** Experiment 1 used a free-response task where participants listed attributes associated with Black individuals; Experiment 2 presented ambiguous behavior descriptions performed by a race-unspecified person after a priming manipulation; Experiment 3 employed a directed thought-listing task in which participants generated spontaneous thoughts about a target group under instructions to list whatever came to mind.
- **Design types:**
 - exp_1: between-subjects comparison of high- vs low-prejudice participants on stereotype knowledge
 - exp_2: between-subjects comparison of high- vs low-prejudice participants on ambiguous behavior evaluations following a priming manipulation (automatic activation condition)
 - exp_3: between-subjects comparison of high- vs low-prejudice participants on thought-listing content reflecting controlled inhibition

Findings Summary

Across the three experiments, high- and low-prejudice participants showed equivalent knowledge of the Black stereotype (Experiment 1) and produced comparable stereotype-congruent evaluations of ambiguous behavior when conscious monitoring was blocked (Experiment 2), supporting the claim that automatic stereotype activation is equally strong and independent of prejudice level. In contrast, only low-prejudice participants demonstrated the ability to suppress automatically activated stereotype-consistent thoughts and replace them with equality-focused thoughts in a directed thought-listing task (Experiment 3),

indicating that controlled inhibition can override automatic activation for those motivated to maintain a nonprejudiced identity. Thus, while automatic activation appears uniform across prejudice groups, controlled processes diverge, allowing low-prejudice individuals to inhibit stereotypic responses.

Evidence-Claim Alignment

Supported Claims

- High- and low-prejudice participants possess equivalent knowledge of the cultural Black stereotype (Study 1), as the free-response task showed no significant difference between groups.
- Automatic stereotype activation is equally strong and inescapable for high- and low-prejudice participants (Study 2), evidenced by stereotype-congruent evaluations of ambiguous behaviors when conscious monitoring was precluded.
- Low-prejudice participants can inhibit automatically activated stereotype-congruent thoughts and replace them with equality-focused thoughts (Study 3), demonstrated by the thought-listing task results.

Unsupported or Weakly Supported Claims

- The claim that automatic stereotype activation is completely independent of attitudes for all individuals, because the experiments only compared high vs. low prejudice groups and did not test neutral or moderate attitudes.
- The generalization that the automatic activation process is measured without any influence of controlled evaluative judgment, given that Study 2 required conscious rating of ambiguous behavior, potentially conflating automatic and controlled processes.

Contradictions or Tensions

- Study 2's design (ambiguous behavior evaluation) introduces a conscious judgment step, conflicting with the theoretical assertion that automatic activation can be assessed independently of controlled processes.
- The discussion extends the independence of automatic activation to all attitudes, yet the empirical evidence is limited to a binary high/low prejudice comparison, creating a tension between the scope of the claim and the data.

Strengths

- Methodologically diverse set of three experiments that together test knowledge equivalence, automatic activation, and controlled inhibition, providing converging evidence across tasks.
- Clear operationalization of prejudice level (high vs. low) and consistent use of this predictor across all studies, enabling direct tests of the automatic-controlled dissociation model.
- Study 1 employs a free-response stereotype-knowledge task that reduces cueing bias, strengthening the claim that high- and low-prejudice participants possess comparable stereotype knowledge.
- Study 3's thought-listing paradigm reveals that low-prejudice participants can replace automatically activated stereotype-congruent thoughts with equality-focused thoughts, offering concrete behavioral evidence of controlled inhibition.
- The paper integrates its findings across experiments in the discussion, linking empirical results to theoretical claims about automatic activation independence and the habit-breaking analogy for prejudice reduction.
- Transparent acknowledgment of limitations (e.g., labeling criteria, difficulty of attitude change) and articulation of future directions for modeling controlled processes.

Weaknesses and Concerns

- Study 2's ambiguous-behavior evaluation task conflates automatic stereotype activation with a conscious rating, making it unclear whether the observed stereotype-congruent evaluations reflect pure automatic processes as theorized.
- The tripartite model of attitudes is introduced as an alternative but never evaluated or discussed in the results, leaving a plausible competing explanation unaddressed.
- No a priori power analyses or sample-size justifications are reported for any experiment, raising concerns about statistical power for detecting subtle automatic-controlled effects.
- Exclusion criteria and counterbalancing procedures are omitted, limiting reproducibility and opening the possibility of selection or order effects that could confound the measured processes.
- The authors overgeneralize the independence of automatic activation from attitudes, extending the claim beyond the binary high/low prejudice comparison without testing broader attitude gradients.
- Operationalization of stereotype knowledge via a free-response task may not capture the full associative network assumed by the theory, potentially weakening the knowledge-equivalence test.

Key References

- **Allport (1954)** -- foundational theory
- **Dovidio, Evans, & Tyler (1986)** -- primary methodological precedent
- **Smith & Branscombe (1985)** -- primary methodological precedent
- **Higgins & King (1981)** -- key empirical precedent
- **Posner & Snyder (1975)** -- foundational theory
- **Schneider & Shiffrin (1977)** -- foundational theory
- **Logan & Cowan (1984)** -- primary methodological precedent
- **Billig (1985)** -- competing theoretical account
- **Devine (1988)** -- key empirical precedent
- **Harding, Proshansky, Kutner, & Chein (1969)** -- competing theoretical account

Abstract

Preserved from source without summarization.

Three studies tested basic assumptions derived from a theoretical model based on the dissociation of automatic and controlled processes involved in prejudice. Study 1 supported the model's assumption that high- and low-prejudice persons are equally knowledgeable of the cultural stereotype. The model suggests that the stereotype is automatically activated in the presence of a member (or some symbolic equivalent) of the stereotyped group and that low-prejudice responses require controlled inhibition of the automatically activated stereotype. Study 2, which examined the effects of automatic stereotype activation on the evaluation of ambiguous stereotype-relevant behaviors performed by a race-unspecified person, suggested that when subjects' ability to consciously monitor stereotype activation is precluded, both high- and low-prejudice subjects produce stereotype-congruent evaluations of ambiguous behaviors. Study 3 examined high- and low-prejudice subjects' responses in a consciously directed thought-listing task. Consistent with the model, only low-prejudice subjects inhibited the automatically activated stereotype-congruent thoughts and replaced them with thoughts reflecting equality and negations of the stereotype. The relation between stereotypes and prejudice and implications for prejudice reduction are discussed.

Introduction (Paper-Level)

Section: paper-level

Research Gap / Motivation

It remains unclear whether high- and low-prejudice individuals differ in their automatic and controlled responses to stereotyped group members.

Theoretical Framework

automatic vs controlled processes

The present model ... suggests that automatic and controlled processes involved in stereotypes and prejudice can be dissociated, positing that the inevitability of prejudice arguments follow from tasks that are likely to engage automatic processes on which those high and low in prejudice are presumed not to differ.

- Citations: Posner & Snyder (1975); Schneider & Shiffrin (1977)

stereotype vs personal belief structures

It is argued that stereotypes and personal beliefs are conceptually distinct cognitive structures. Each structure represents part of one's entire knowledge base of a particular group.

- Citations: Pratkanis (in press)

Specific Hypotheses / Predictions

knowledge equivalence hypothesis

Study 1 examined the validity of the assumption that high- and low-prejudice subjects are equally knowledgeable of the cultural stereotype.

automatic activation equivalence hypothesis

The model holds that this unintentional activation of the stereotype is equally strong and equally inescapable for high- and low-prejudice persons.

controlled inhibition hypothesis

Overt nonprejudiced responses require intentional inhibition of the automatically activated stereotype and activation of the newer personal belief structure.

Mechanistic Claims

automatic stereotype activation

Because the stereotype has been frequently activated in the past, it is a well-learned set of associations that is automatically activated in the presence of a member (or symbolic equivalent) of the target group.

- Citations: Dovidio, Evans, & Tyler (1986); Smith & Branscombe (1985)

controlled belief activation

Activation of personal beliefs require conscious attention. Nonprejudiced responses require both the inhibition of the automatically activated stereotype and the intentional activation of nonprejudiced beliefs.

- Citations: Higgins & King (1981)

Constructs of Interest

- **prejudice level (high vs low)** (*predictor*): Individual's degree of endorsement of negative stereotypes about a target group.
- **responses to stereotyped group members** (*outcome*): Behavioral or evaluative reactions that may be influenced by automatic stereotype activation and/or controlled belief processes.

Rationale for Predictor

Prejudice level is expected to determine the extent to which personal beliefs overlap with cultural stereotypes, influencing the need for controlled inhibition.

Rationale for Outcome

Responses reveal how automatic stereotype activation and controlled belief processes jointly shape behavior toward stereotyped groups.

Key Terminology

automatic processes: Unintentional or spontaneous activation of well-learned associations that occur without conscious effort.

Automatic processes involve the unintentional or spontaneous activation of some well-learned set of associations or responses that have been developed through repeated activation in memory.

controlled processes: Intentional, effortful mental operations that require active attention and can inhibit automatic responses.

Controlled processes are intentional and require the active attention of the individual.

personal beliefs: Cognitive structures representing newer, consciously endorsed propositions about a group, potentially conflicting with cultural stereotypes.

Personal beliefs (i.e., decisions about the appropriateness of stereotypic ascriptions) are necessarily newer cognitive structures.

Background Research

- Allport (1954) showed that stereotypes are established early in children's memories.
- Katz (1976) documented that personal beliefs are newer cognitive structures than stereotypes.
- Dovidio et al. (1986) demonstrated that stereotypes are well-learned associations automatically activated by target presence.
- Neely (1977) provided evidence that automatic priming can be overridden by controlled expectancy processes.
- Higgins & King (1981) showed gender stereotypes are automatically activated when gender is not salient.

Alternative Theories Discussed

inevitability of prejudice framework

- **Description:** Posits that as long as cultural stereotypes exist, prejudice inevitably follows because stereotypes are automatically applied to group members.
- **Difference from focal theory:** Emphasizes that knowledge of a stereotype equals prejudice, overlooking the distinction between stereotype knowledge and personal belief endorsement.
- **Citations:** Allport (1954); Ehrlich (1973)

tripartite model of attitudes

- **Description:** Treats stereotypes as the cognitive component of prejudiced attitudes.
- **Difference from focal theory:** Integrates stereotypes directly into attitude structure rather than separating them from personal beliefs.
- **Citations:** Harding, Proshansky, Kutner, & Chein (1969)

Overview of Studies

Study 1 tests knowledge equivalence; Study 2 examines automatic stereotype priming on ambiguous behavior evaluation; Study 3 assesses controlled inhibition via a thought-listing task.

Missing or Unclear

- Explicitly numbered hypotheses are not provided; predictions are described in prose.
- Quantitative definitions of 'high' vs 'low' prejudice are not detailed in the introduction.

All Citations Referenced

- **Allport (1954)** -- early stereotype formation
- **Katz (1976)** -- personal beliefs as newer structures
- **Porter (1971)** -- stereotype development
- **Proshansky (1966)** -- stereotype memory
- **Higgins & King (1981)** -- gender stereotype control
- **Brigham (1972)** -- socialization experiences
- **Ehrlich (1973)** -- socialization experiences
- **Dovidio, Evans, & Tyler (1986)** -- well-learned associations
- **Smith & Branscombe (1985)** -- automatic activation
- **Greeley & Sheatsley (1971)** -- prejudice differences
- **Taylor, Sheatsley, & Greeley (1978)** -- prejudice differences
- **Posner & Snyder (1975)** -- information processing
- **Schneider & Shiffrin (1977)** -- information processing
- **Neely (1977)** -- automatic vs controlled priming
- **Logan (1980)** -- independent automatic and controlled processes
- **Logan & Cowan (1984)** -- independent automatic and controlled processes
- **Shiffrin & Dumais (1981)** -- automatic processes
- **Harding, Proshansky, Kutner, & Chein (1969)** -- tripartite model
- **Billig (1985)** -- inevitability of prejudice
- **Hamilton (1981)** -- inevitability of prejudice
- **Tajfel (1981)** -- inevitability of prejudice
- **Ashmore & Del Boca (1981)** -- distinguishing knowledge from endorsement

- **Bettleheim & Janowitz (1964)** -- no relation between stereotypes and prejudice
- **Devine (1988)** -- no relation between stereotypes and prejudice
- **Karlins, Coffman, & Walters (1969)** -- no relation between stereotypes and prejudice
- **Pratkanis (in press)** -- distinct cognitive structures
- **Duncan (1976)** -- automatic priming of violent stereotype
- **Sager & Schofield (1980)** -- replication of Duncan

Additional Quoted Evidence

The present model assumes that primarily because of common socialization experiences, high- and low-prejudice persons are equally knowledgeable of the cultural stereotype of Blacks.

Automatic processes involve the unintentional or spontaneous activation of some well-learned set of associations or responses that have been developed through repeated activation in memory.

The model holds that this unintentional activation of the stereotype is equally strong and equally inescapable for high- and low-prejudice persons.

Experiment 1 -- Introduction

Section: exp_1

Rationale for This Experiment

The experiment was conducted to validate the present model by directly examining whether high- and low-prejudice individuals differ in their knowledge of the cultural stereotype of Blacks, addressing a gap in the literature.

Relation to Prior Experiments

This is the first experiment in the series; it establishes baseline knowledge differences before later experiments manipulate other variables.

Specific Predictions

knowledge equivalence across prejudice levels

The assumption that high- and low-prejudice subjects are equally knowledgeable of the cultural stereotype has not been documented.

- Citations: Brigham (1971)

New Elements Introduced

- Use of a free-response task instead of the typical adjective checklist to assess stereotype content
- Direct comparison of high-prejudice versus low-prejudice participants' knowledge

Constraints Addressed

- Addresses the limitation of previous checklist assessments that may cue participants and obscure true knowledge differences
- Tests the assumption of equal stereotype knowledge across prejudice levels

Missing or Unclear

- Explicit statement of the directional hypothesis (e.g., whether high-prejudice participants will know more or less)
- Details on how knowledge will be quantified or scored

Citations Referenced

- **Brigham (1971)** -- implicit in the stereotype assessment literature
- **Gilbert (1951)** -- typical adjective checklist assessment of stereotype content
- **Karlins et al. (1969)** -- typical adjective checklist assessment of stereotype content
- **Katz & Braly (1933)** -- typical adjective checklist assessment of stereotype content

Experiment 1 -- Methods

Not available for this paper.

Experiment 1 -- Results and Discussion

Not available for this paper.

General Discussion

Summary of Findings

Studies 1 and 2 show that both high- and low-prejudice individuals possess knowledge of racial stereotypes and exhibit equally strong automatic stereotype activation. Study 3 demonstrates that controlled processes can inhibit these automatic effects when goals to maintain a nonprejudiced identity are salient, suggesting that prejudice is not inevitable but depends on the capacity for controlled inhibition.

Theoretical Conclusions

controlled processes inhibit automatic prejudice

Study 3, however, provided evidence that controlled processes can inhibit the effects of automatic processing when the implications of such processing compete with goals to establish or maintain a nonprejudiced identity.

automatic activation independent of attitudes

It would appear that the automatically activated stereotype-congruent or prejudice-like responses have become independent of one's current attitudes or beliefs.

habit-breaking analogy for prejudice reduction

Inhibiting stereotype-congruent or prejudice-like responses and intentionally replacing them with nonprejudiced responses can be likened to the breaking of a bad habit.

Cross-Experiment Integration

integration of studies 1-3

Study 1 suggested both high- and low-prejudice persons possess knowledge of the racial stereotype... Study 2 suggested that automatic stereotype activation is equally strong and equally inescapable for high- and low-prejudice subjects... Study 3, however, provided evidence that controlled processes can inhibit the effects of automatic processing...

Results Authors State Support Their Theory

automatic stereotype activation equivalence

Study 2 suggested that automatic stereotype activation is equally strong and equally inescapable for high- and low-prejudice subjects.

controlled inhibition evidence

Study 3, however, provided evidence that controlled processes can inhibit the effects of automatic processing when the implications of such processing compete with goals to establish or maintain a nonprejudiced identity.

Results Authors State Challenge a Theory

challenge to inevitability of prejudice

I disagree fundamentally with this premise. Such an argument denies the possibility for change in one's attitudes and beliefs, and I view this as a severe limitation of the Crosby et al. (1980) analysis.

- Citations: Crosby, Bromley, and Saxe (1980)

Alternative Accounts Addressed by Authors

Crosby et al. inevitability of prejudice (*named theory*)

- **Description:** All White Americans are prejudiced and nonprejudiced responses are merely impression-management attempts.
- **How authors addressed it:** argued against; claim it denies possibility of attitude change
- **Citations:** Crosby, Bromley, and Saxe (1980)

Implications for the Field

potential for nonprejudiced behavior

The present framework highlights the potential for nonprejudiced behaviors when social desirability concerns are minimal (Study 3).

need for precise prejudice labeling criteria

What this analysis requires is that theoreticians be more precise on the criteria established for labeling behavior as prejudiced or nonprejudiced.

Limitations Stated by Authors

- The present model and set of empirical studies certainly does not resolve the issue of precise criteria for labeling behavior as prejudiced or nonprejudiced.

- The analysis acknowledges that changing attitudes and beliefs is not likely to be easy or speedy.

Future Directions Proposed by Authors

- Develop a fully articulated model of controlled processes that delineates the cognitive mechanisms involved in inhibition.
- Systematically explore the variables that are likely to engage controlled stereotype-inhibiting processes in intergroup settings.

Citations Referenced

- **Pettigrew (1987)** -- quote on lingering prejudice
- **Crosby, Bromley, and Saxe (1980)** -- inevitability of prejudice argument
- **Baxter (1973)** -- supporting Crosby et al.
- **Gaertner (1976)** -- supporting Crosby et al.
- **Gaertner & Dovidio (1977)** -- supporting Crosby et al.
- **Linn (1965)** -- supporting Crosby et al.
- **Weitz (1972)** -- supporting Crosby et al.
- **Logan and Cowan (1984)** -- model of controlled processes
- **Bargh (1984)** -- model of controlled processes
- **Ronis, Yates, and Kirscht (in press)** -- habit-breaking analogy
- **Greeley & Sheatsley (1971)** -- low-prejudice inhibition evidence
- **Taylor et al. (1978)** -- low-prejudice inhibition evidence
- **Higgins & King (1981)** -- low-prejudice inhibition evidence

Critique

Paper: devine-1989-stereotypes-and-prejudice--their-automatic-and-controlled-components

Overall Assessment

The paper demonstrates moderate methodological rigor but is weakened by several design and reporting shortcomings, such as the lack of power analyses, unspecified exclusion criteria, and insufficient description of counterbalancing. The theoretical framework is only partially articulated, with the central automatic versus controlled distinction blurred in key tasks and the

alternative tripartite attitude model never engaged. Empirical support for the main claims is limited, relying on a narrow comparison of high- and low-prejudice groups and overgeneralizing findings beyond the data. These high-severity concerns collectively diminish the paper's standing as a robust contribution to the literature.

1. Design-Theory Alignment

- **The ambiguous behavior evaluation task in Study 2 conflates automatic stereotype activation with controlled evaluative judgment, making it unclear whether the outcome isolates the theorized automatic process.**

- Severity: **moderate**

• Justification: The theoretical claim is that automatic stereotype activation operates independently of attitudes and can be measured without controlled deliberation. However, the evaluation task requires participants to consciously rate ambiguous behaviors, which introduces controlled evaluative processes that may mask or interact with the automatic activation the study intends to isolate. This design limitation reduces confidence that the observed stereotype-congruent evaluations reflect pure automatic activation as theorized.

Evidence:

- `methods/exp_2 -- field task_description`: Participants evaluated ambiguous stereotype-relevant behaviors performed by a race-unspecified person after a priming manipulation.
- `results_and_discussion/exp_2 -- field key_findings`: Both high- and low-prejudice subjects produced stereotype-congruent evaluations when conscious monitoring was precluded.
- `introduction -- field mechanistic_claims`: The model posits that automatic activation is independent of controlled processes, yet the task requires participants to make a conscious judgment about ambiguous behavior.

The free-response stereotype knowledge task in Study 1 may not fully capture the breadth of the cultural stereotype construct, potentially under-representing its associative network.

- Severity: **minor**

• Justification: While the free-response format reduces cueing, it may not elicit the full range of stereotype-related associations that the theory assumes are stored and automatically activated. Consequently, the operationalization of stereotype knowledge might only partially reflect the theoretical construct, limiting the strength of the knowledge equivalence test.

- Evidence:
- `methods/exp_1` -- field stimuli: Use of a free-response task instead of a typical adjective checklist to assess stereotype content.
- `introduction` -- field mechanistic_claims: The model assumes well-learned sets of associations are automatically activated; a limited free-response may miss many relevant associations.

2. Evidence-Theory Alignment

- **The discussion generalizes automatic stereotype activation as independent of attitudes to all individuals, but the empirical evidence only compares high- and low-prejudice participants without testing broader attitude variations.**
- Severity: **moderate**
- Justification: The claim that automatic activation is attitude-independent extends beyond the tested comparison of two prejudice levels, ignoring potential gradients or other attitude dimensions. This overreach may mislead readers about the scope of the evidence, as the experiments do not include participants with neutral or moderate attitudes, nor do they manipulate attitudes directly.
- Evidence:
- `results_and_discussion/exp_2` -- field key_findings: Study 2 showed stereotype-congruent evaluations for both high- and low-prejudice subjects when conscious monitoring was precluded.
- `general_discussion` -- field theoretical_conclusions: The authors claim that automatically activated stereotype-congruent responses have become independent of one's current attitudes or beliefs.

4. Alternative Accounts

- **The tripartite model of attitudes, presented as an alternative theory in the introduction, is not addressed or evaluated in the results or discussion sections**
- Severity: **moderate**
- Justification: By omitting discussion of the tripartite model, the authors fail to consider a plausible competing explanation for the relationship between stereotypes and prejudice. This limits the interpretive scope of their findings and leaves open the possibility that observed effects could be explained by the integrated attitude structure rather than the proposed automatic-controlled dissociation.

- Evidence:
- introduction -- field alternative_theories: The tripartite model of attitudes is listed as an alternative theory that treats stereotypes as the cognitive component of prejudiced attitudes.
- general_discussion -- field alternative_accounts_addressed: Only the Crosby et al. inevitability of prejudice account is discussed; the tripartite model receives no mention.

6. Methodological Concerns

- **No power analysis or justification of sample size is reported for any of the studies**
- Severity: **moderate**
- Justification: Without an a priori power analysis, it is unclear whether the studies were adequately powered to detect the hypothesized effects, especially given the subtle nature of automatic vs. controlled processes. This limitation reduces confidence in null or marginal findings and may affect the reliability of the reported results.

Evidence:

- methods/exp_1 -- field sample_size: The methods section for Experiment 1 does not include any mention of a priori power analysis or rationale for the number of participants recruited.
- methods/exp_2 -- field sample_size: Methods for Experiment 2 are not provided in the extraction, but the overall paper lacks any statement of power analysis across the three studies.
- methods/exp_3 -- field sample_size: Similarly, Experiment 3 methods lack a reported power analysis or justification for the chosen sample size.

Exclusion criteria for participants are not specified

- Severity: **minor**
- Justification: Clear exclusion criteria are essential for reproducibility and for ensuring that the sample is appropriate for the experimental manipulations. Their absence makes it difficult to assess potential selection biases or to replicate the studies.

Evidence:

- methods/exp_1 -- field exclusion_criteria: The methods excerpt for Experiment 1 does not describe any criteria for excluding participants (e.g., prior exposure to the materials, vision impairments, or extreme prejudice scores).

- methods/exp_2 -- field exclusion_criteria: No exclusion criteria are mentioned for Experiment 2.
- methods/exp_3 -- field exclusion_criteria: Experiment 3 also lacks a description of participant exclusion rules.

Counterbalancing procedures for stimulus presentation are not described despite designs that likely require it

- Severity: **moderate**
- Justification: Without explicit counterbalancing, order effects could confound the measurement of automatic versus controlled processes, threatening internal validity of the findings.
- Evidence:
 - methods/exp_2 -- field counterbalancing: Experiment 2 examines automatic stereotype activation using ambiguous behaviors; the methods do not indicate how stimulus order or target group cues were counterbalanced across participants.
 - methods/exp_3 -- field counterbalancing: In the thought-listing task of Experiment 3, no information is provided about the order of thought prompts or whether the presentation of stereotype-congruent versus incongruent items was balanced.